Treaty saw the introduction of the procedure of co-decision with the Council to give a greater say in the European parliament in the legislative process, but this position of co-decision does not extend to all the policy areas. Therefore, there is a so-called democratic deficit in the EU. As a result of widening of the EU, there is a growing demand for reforms of the EU norms to ensure distribution of powers between the member states. Further, deepening of European integration has been achieved through the process of economic integration. However, in the policy fields the principles of subsidiarity and proportionality still operate which are rather abstract and the difference between them is often blurred. The CFSP is another crucial challenge before the EU. It is said, “If one digs deeper into the structure and functioning, it [the CFSP] is neither common, nor foreign, nor dealing with security, nor can be called a policy. Yet, most observers and policy-makers use the acronym CFSP like a magic formula: it is enough to invoke the name and the EU turns into a major actor—if not a superpower—in world affairs. The paradox is that this mantra effect is even stronger outside Europe than inside”. [21]

The other kind of threats perceived by the EU range from international terrorism, weapons of mass destruction (WMDs), failed states, regional conflicts due to expansion of the EU to the conflict-prone zone in Central Asia, and organized crimes (See also Eurozone Crisis, pages 511–512).